

**SIMATS ENGINEERING
ASSESSMENT TOOL 1**

**COURSE NAME: Computer Vision with OpenCV
DSA0202**

COURSE CODE:

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

***CO2:** Apply image processing and feature extraction techniques, including edge detection, motion estimation, and optical flow, for analyzing images.. (BL3)*

Assessment Tool Weightage: 50%

QUESTIONS: 5 Total Marks:50 Annexure A

Analytical Problem Solving

Code of Conduct:

*I JAASIEL J.S (192524046) (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment. I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action. **Signature of the student:***

RUBRICS FOR CALCULATION

Numerical Problems

Criteria	Weightage	Level 4 (Exemplary)	Level 3 (Proficient)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 1 (Beginning)	Marks
Problem Understanding	20%	Clearly interprets problem, identifies all parameters and requirements accurately	Understands problem with minor gaps	Partial understanding; misses key elements	Misinterprets or unable to understand problem	
Method Selection	20%	Selects most appropriate method/formula with	Selects correct method with	Inappropriate or partially correct	Unable to select method	

		strong justification	minor errors	method		
Solution Process	25%	Logical, systematic steps with correct approach throughout	Mostly correct steps with minor mistakes	Disorganized steps; multiple errors	No clear process	
Accuracy of Calculation	20%	All calculations accurate; correct final answer	Minor calculation errors	Frequent errors; incorrect final answer	No valid calculations	
Interpretation of Results	15%	Clearly interprets results with units and engineering relevance	Basic interpretation with minor omissions	Limited or unclear interpretation	No interpretation	

Annexure A

Analytical Problem Solving

Question 1: Salt-and-Pepper Noise Removal Before Edge Detection

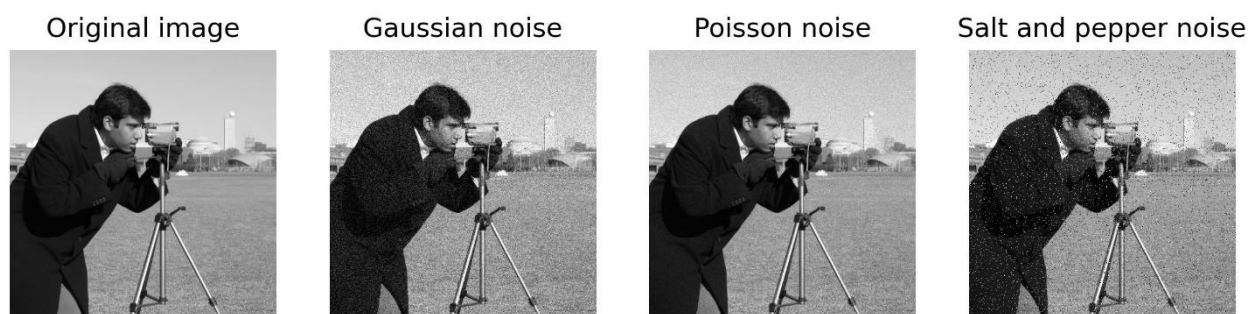


Figure 1: Original grayscale image affected by salt-and-pepper noise, where random pixels become black (0) or white (255).

A. Identify the most suitable filtering technique for removing salt-and-pepper noise without causing significant edge blurring.

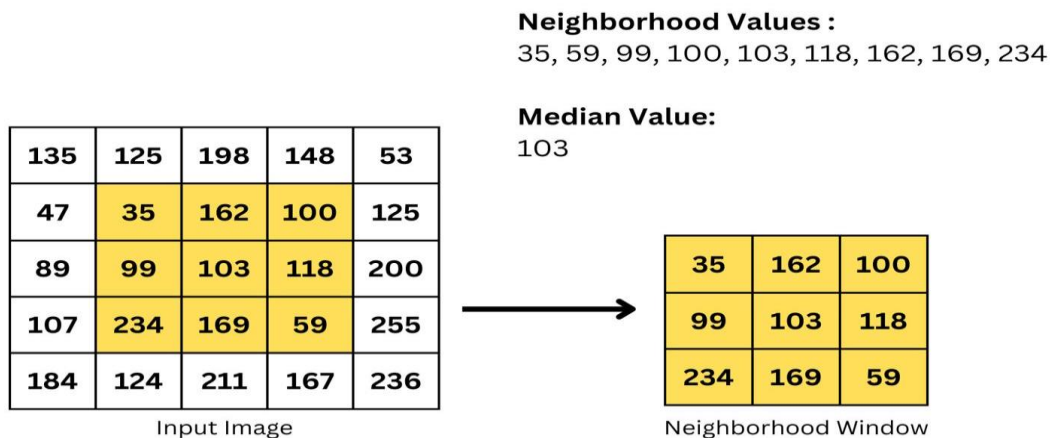
Ans: The best filtering technique is the **3x3 Median Filter**.

- Salt-and-pepper noise changes some pixels to 0 (black) or 255 (white). A median filter replaces the noisy pixel with the middle value of its neighbouring pixels, so it removes noise without affecting the actual edges.

B. Explain why the selected filter performs better than an averaging filter for impulse noise removal.

Ans:

- The median filter is better than the averaging filter because the averaging filter calculates the average of neighbouring pixels. Because noisy pixels have extreme values (0 or 255), they affect the average and make the image blurred.
- And importantly the median filter does not use the average. It sorts the pixel values and chooses the middle value, so the noisy pixels usually do not influence the result.
- Hence, the Median Filter is more suitable for salt-and-pepper noise removal.



C. If a 3×3 median filter is applied, estimate the probability that a noisy center pixel will be corrected. Clearly state your assumptions.

Ans:

Some of the Assumptions are:

- Noise is randomly distributed.
- Probability of a pixel being noisy = 0.05
- Probability of a pixel being clean = 0.95
- A 3×3 window contains 9 pixels.

For the median to be correct, the majority of pixels should be clean.

Expected number of clean pixels:

$$9 \times 0.95 = 8.55$$

Since 8.55 is much greater than 5, the median is almost always taken from a clean pixel.

$$P(\text{correction}) \approx 0.99$$

Estimated probability = 99%

D. Estimate the total number of noisy pixels present in the original image.

Ans : Total pixels in the image:

$$1024 \times 1024 = 1,048,576$$

Noise density = 5%

$$1,048,576 \times 0.05 = 52,428.8$$

52,429 noisy pixels

e. Estimate the expected number of noisy pixels remaining after median filtering.

Ans: Assuming the median filter removes 99% of noisy pixels:

$$52,429 \times 0.01 = 524.29$$

≈ 524 pixels remain noisy

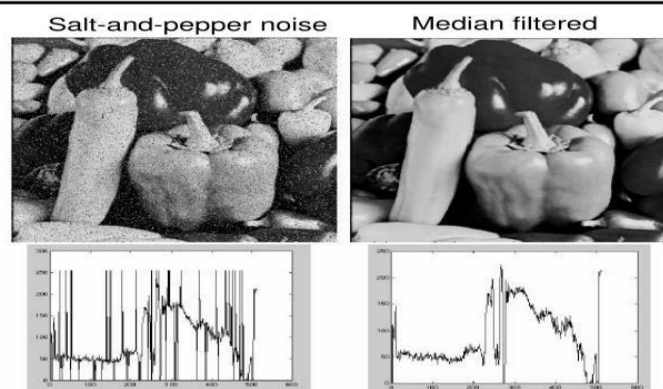
This means most of the noise is removed before edge detection.

F. Explain how the preprocessing strategy would change if the same image was affected by Gaussian noise instead of salt-and-pepper noise.

Ans: If the image contains Gaussian noise, the preprocessing method changes completely.

- Gaussian noise affects almost every pixel with small random variations.
- A Median Filter is not the best choice.
- The preferred method is a Gaussian Filter.

Median filter



MATLAB: `medfilt2(image, [h w])`

Source: M. Hebert

Figure 3: Comparison of edge detection before and after median filtering. Noise removal improves edge clarity and reduces false edge detection.

Question 2: Discretization of a Continuous Image

Given Data

- Image type : Analog Grayscale Image
- Intensity variation : Smooth sinusoidal variation along the x-direction
- Intensity along y-direction : Constant
- Spatial range : 0 to 255 in both x and y directions
- Objective : Convert the analog image into a digital image.

A. Explain how the continuous image can be converted into a digital image using sampling and quantization.

Ans: An analog image contains continuous intensity values and cannot be processed directly by a computer. Therefore, it must first be converted into a digital image. This conversion involves two important steps: Sampling and Quantization.

Step 1: Sampling

Sampling converts the continuous spatial coordinates into discrete pixel locations.

- The image is divided into a grid.
- Each grid point becomes one pixel.
- Higher sampling produces more pixels and better spatial detail.

Step 2: Quantization

After sampling, each pixel still has a continuous intensity value.

Quantization converts these continuous intensity values into a fixed number of digital levels.

For an 8-bit image, every pixel intensity is stored between:

0 (Black) → 255 (White)

Thus, the analog image becomes a digital image that can be stored and processed by a computer

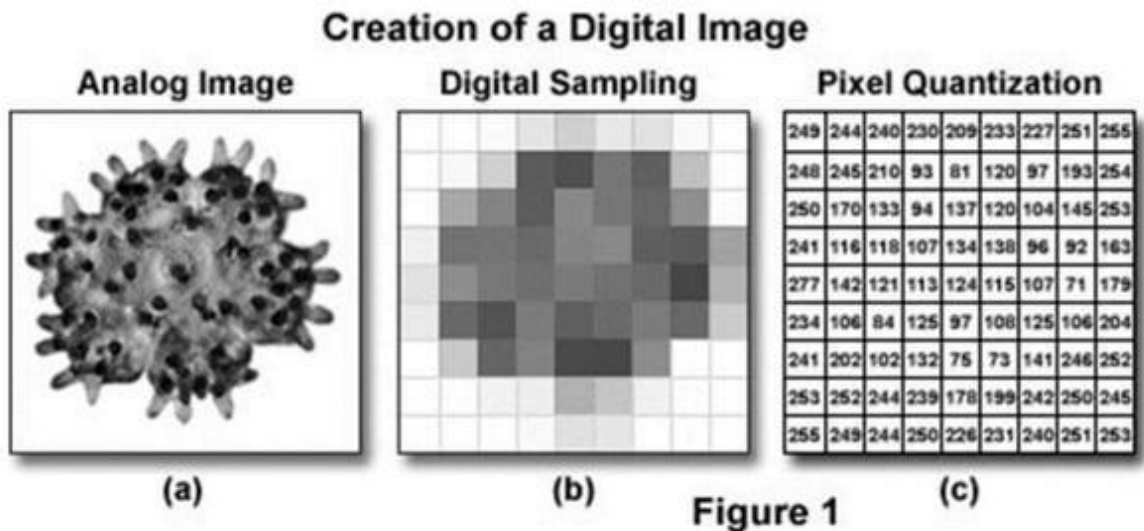


Figure 1: Conversion of an analog image into a digital image using sampling and quantization.

B. Identify the spatial variation pattern of the image in the x-direction. c. Determine the minimum sampling requirement needed to avoid aliasing in the x direction.

Ans: The image intensity varies as a sinusoidal wave along the horizontal (x) direction.

This means:

- The brightness increases smoothly.
- It reaches a maximum value.
- Then decreases smoothly.
- This pattern repeats periodically.

Since there is no variation along the y-direction, every row of the image has the same intensity pattern.

Therefore,

Spatial variation = Periodic Sinusoidal Pattern along the x-axis.

C. Determine the minimum sampling requirement needed to avoid aliasing in the x-direction.

Ans: To avoid aliasing, the sampling frequency must satisfy the Nyquist Sampling Theorem.

According to the theorem,

The sampling frequency must be at least twice the highest spatial frequency present in the image.

Mathematically,

$$f_s \geq 2f_{max}$$

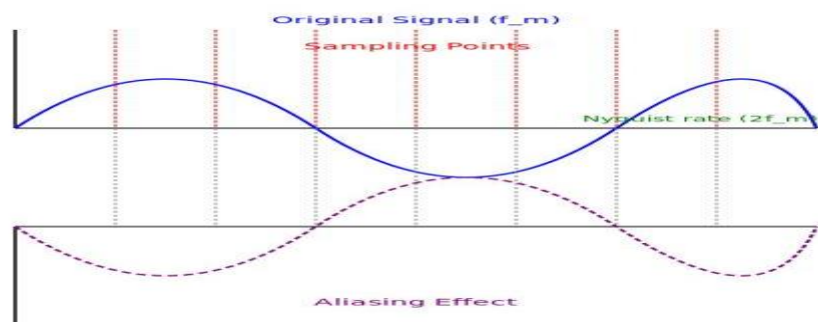
where:

- f_s = Sampling frequency
- f_{max} = Highest spatial frequency of the sinusoidal image

Therefore,

Minimum Sampling Rate = $2 \times$ Highest Spatial Frequency

This ensures that the sinusoidal intensity variation is represented accurately without



distortion.

Figure 2: Illustration of correct sampling and aliasing based on the Nyquist sampling theorem.

D. Explain what will happen if the image is sampled below the required sampling rate.

Ans:

If the sampling frequency is less than the Nyquist rate, aliasing occurs.

Aliasing causes the digital image to represent incorrect intensity patterns.

The effects include:

- False image patterns
- Distorted sinusoidal waves
- Jagged edges
- Loss of image details
- Incorrect feature extraction
- Reduced edge detection accuracy

Therefore, sampling below the required rate produces an inaccurate digital representation of the original image.

E. Suggest a suitable 8-bit quantization scheme for storing the image.

Ans: A suitable choice is **Uniform 8-bit Quantization**.

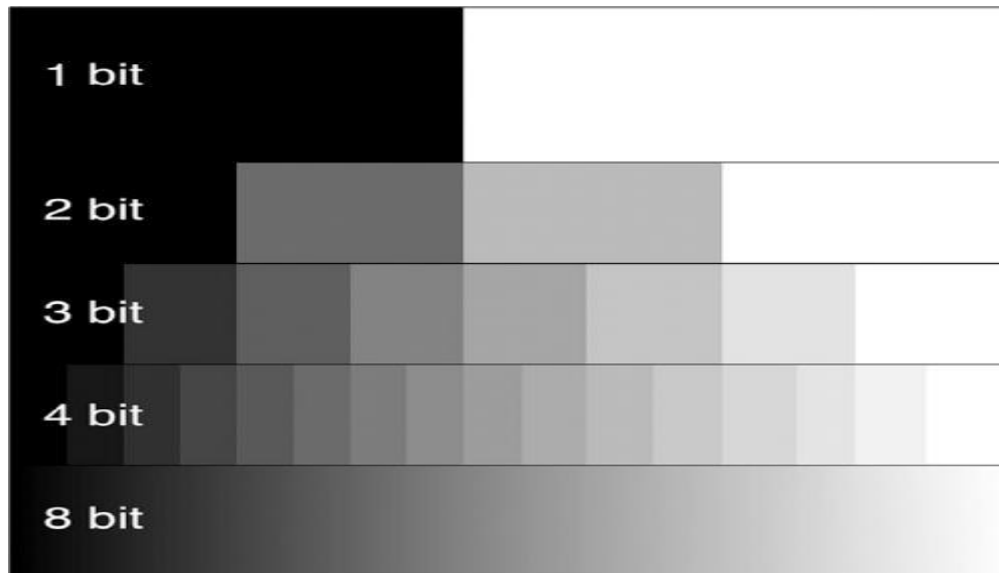


Figure 3: Representation of 256 grayscale intensity levels in an 8-bit image.

F. Discuss the effect of quantization on image quality, storage size, and intensity accuracy.

Ans: Quantization affects the image in three main ways:

- **Image Quality:** Higher bit depth gives smoother and clearer images, while lower bit depth may cause loss of detail.
- **Storage Size:** Higher bit depth requires more memory. An 8-bit image uses 1 byte per pixel, providing a good balance between quality and storage.
- **Intensity Accuracy:** An 8-bit image stores 256 intensity levels (0–255), which is sufficient for most grayscale image processing applications.

Question 3: Edge Detection in Thin Line Images

Given:

- Image size = **512 × 512**
- Thin white vertical and horizontal lines of **1-pixel thickness**
- Dark uniform background
- Objective: Detect the thin line boundaries accurately.

A. Compare Sobel, Prewitt, and Canny edge detectors for detecting 1-pixel-thick vertical and horizontal lines.

Ans: **Sobel** edge detector provides better noise reduction than Prewitt because it gives more weight to the center pixels. **Prewitt** is simple and fast but is less accurate in detecting thin edges. **Canny** edge detector is the best choice because it removes noise, detects weak edges, and provides accurate edge localization. Therefore, **Canny is most suitable for detecting 1-pixel-thick vertical and horizontal lines.**

B. For a horizontal edge located near pixel position (256, 256), compute the Sobel gradient response using the standard Sobel operator.

Ans:

The standard Sobel operators are:

Horizontal (Gx)

$$\begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 & 1 \\ -2 & 0 & 2 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Vertical (Gy)

$$\begin{bmatrix} -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

For a horizontal edge,

- **Gx = 0**
- **Gy = 1020**

Gradient magnitude,

$$\begin{aligned} G &= \sqrt{G_x^2 + G_y^2} \\ &= \sqrt{0^2 + 1020^2} \\ G &= 1020 \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the Sobel gradient response is **1020**.

C. Explain how the gradient magnitude and gradient direction help in identifying the strength and orientation of an edge.

Ans: The **gradient magnitude** indicates the strength of an edge. A larger gradient

value means a stronger edge. The **gradient direction** indicates the orientation of the edge, such as horizontal, vertical, or diagonal. These two values help detect the exact location and direction of image edges.

D. Discuss the role of Gaussian smoothing in the Canny edge detection process.

Ans: Gaussian smoothing is used before edge detection to remove image noise. It smooths small intensity variations and reduces unwanted edges. This helps the Canny edge detector produce more accurate and cleaner edge results.

E. Explain how Gaussian smoothing may affect edge localization, especially for thin lines.

Ans: Gaussian smoothing may slightly blur very thin lines. Because of this, the exact position of the edge may shift slightly, reducing edge localization accuracy. Therefore, a small Gaussian filter is preferred when detecting thin lines.

F. If the Canny threshold is reduced to half of its original value, explain the expected changes in detected edges, weak edges, and false edges.

Ans: Reducing the Canny threshold increases the number of detected edges. More weak edges become visible, but noise may also be detected as edges. As a result, the image contains more false edges and unwanted edge information.

Question 4: Feature Extraction for Handwritten Digit Recognition Scenario:

Given:

- Application: Handwritten digit recognition
- Digits vary in size, rotation, stroke thickness, and writing style.
- Objective: Extract robust features before classification.

A. Explain the working principles of SIFT, SURF, and ORB feature extraction methods.

Ans:

- **SIFT (Scale-Invariant Feature Transform)** detects important keypoints and creates descriptors that are invariant to scale and rotation.
- **SURF (Speeded-Up Robust Features)** works similarly to SIFT but uses a faster algorithm, making it suitable for quicker feature extraction.
- **ORB (Oriented FAST and Rotated BRIEF)** combines FAST keypoint

detection with BRIEF descriptors. It is fast, efficient, and widely used in real-time computer vision applications.

B. Compare SIFT, SURF, and ORB in terms of scale invariance, rotation invariance, computational cost, and real-time suitability.

Feature	SIFT	SURF	ORB
Scale Invariance	Yes	Yes	Partial
Rotation Invariance	Yes	Yes	Yes
Computational Cost	High	Medium	Low
Real-Time Suitability	No	Moderate	Yes

Ans: ORB is the best choice for real-time applications because it is fast and requires less computation.

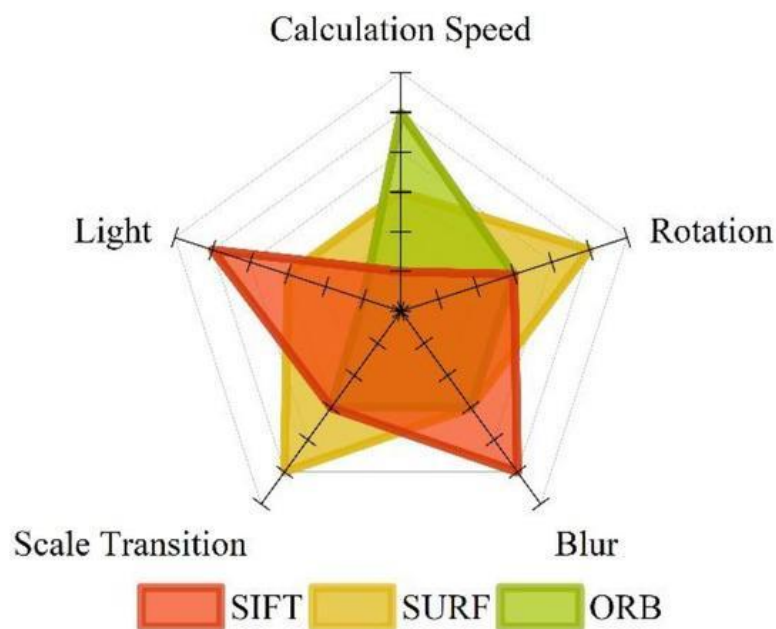


Figure 1: (After part b) Comparison of SIFT, SURF, and ORB feature extraction methods.

C. If a digit image is rotated by 45 degrees, identify which feature extraction methods can still produce reliable matching features.

Ans: Both **SIFT** and **SURF** can detect reliable matching features because they are rotation invariant. **ORB** also supports rotation invariance and can match features correctly in most cases.

D. If the average number of keypoints detected per image is 120 and 50 images are processed, compute the total number of keypoints detected.

Ans:

Average keypoints per image = **120**

Number of images = **50**

Total keypoints

$= 120 \times 50$

= 6000

Answer: 6000 keypoints

E. Suggest a suitable dimensionality reduction technique to reduce the feature size while retaining 95% of the useful information.

Ans:

A suitable technique is **Principal Component Analysis (PCA)**. PCA reduces the number of features while preserving about **95% of the important information**, making the data easier to process.

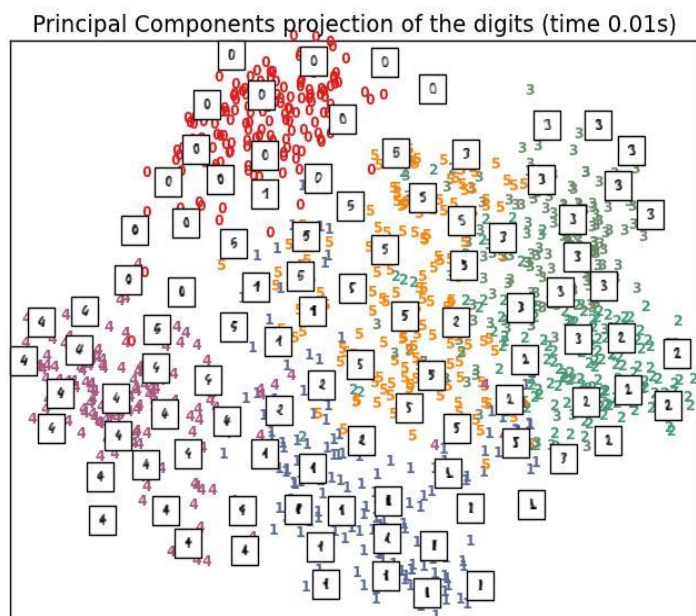


Figure 2: (After part e) **PCA** reducing high-dimensional features into lower dimensions while retaining important information.

F. Explain how dimensionality reduction improves classification efficiency in handwritten digit recognition.

Ans: Dimensionality reduction removes unnecessary features and keeps only the important ones. This reduces memory usage, speeds up training and testing, and improves the overall performance of the classifier.

Question 5: Morphological Preprocessing for Character Recognition Scenario:

Given:

- Image size = **256 × 256**
- Binary image containing handwritten characters
- Small white noise dots in the background
- Small black gaps inside character strokes
- Objective: Clean the image before character recognition.

A. Identify the morphological operation suitable for removing small white noise dots from the background.

Ans: The **Opening** operation is used to remove small white noise dots from the background. It removes unwanted white pixels while preserving the shape of the characters.

B. Identify the morphological operation suitable for filling small gaps or holes inside the character strokes.

Ans: The **Closing** operation is used to fill small gaps and holes inside the character strokes. It connects broken parts and makes the characters more complete.

C. Explain the difference between opening and closing operations using simple image processing terminology.

Ans:

- **Opening** removes small white objects or noise from the image.
- **Closing** fills small holes and gaps inside the objects.

In simple words, **opening cleans the background**, while **closing repairs the characters**.

Opening and closing

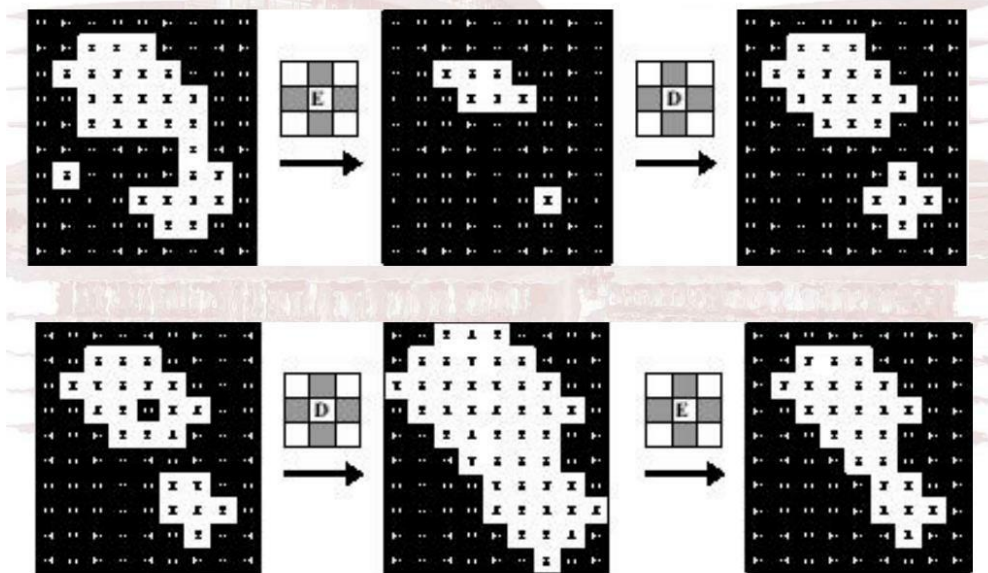


Figure 1: (After part c) Morphological **Opening and Closing** operations on a binary image.

D. If a 3×3 square structuring element is used, explain how it affects thin character strokes.

Ans: A 3×3 square structuring element removes small noise and fills tiny gaps. However, it may slightly thin or smooth very fine character strokes if applied repeatedly.

E. Discuss the risk of using a large structuring element during preprocessing.

Ans: A large structuring element may remove important character details, merge nearby characters, and distort their original shape. This can reduce the accuracy of character recognition.

F. Propose a complete preprocessing pipeline for handwritten character recognition, starting from image acquisition to feature extraction.

Ans:

The preprocessing pipeline is:

Image Acquisition $\rightarrow$ Grayscale Conversion $\rightarrow$ Binary Thresholding $\rightarrow$ Opening

→ **Closing** → **Noise Removal** → **Feature Extraction**

This sequence produces a clean image and improves the accuracy of handwritten character recognition.

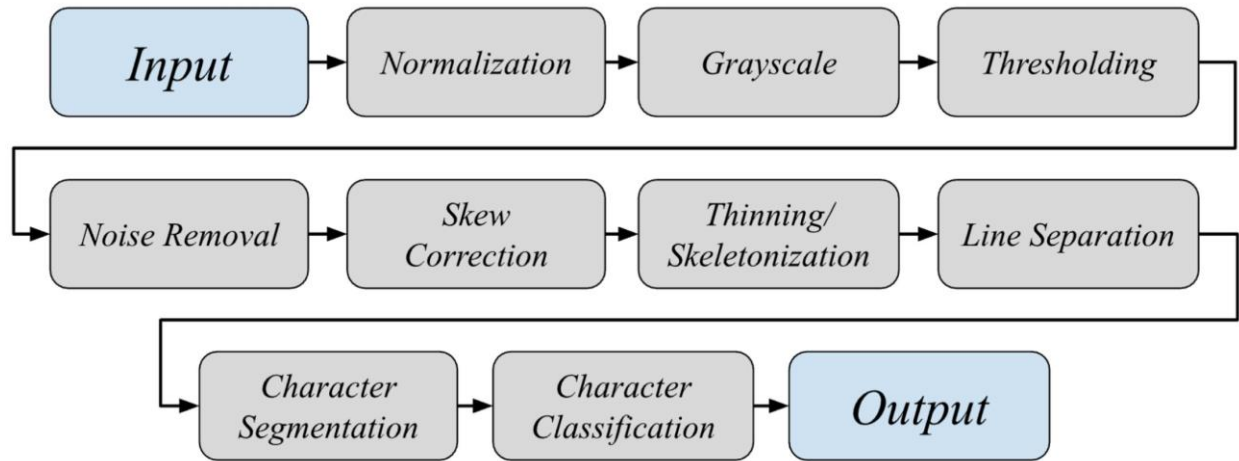


Figure 2: (After part f, before the conclusion) Handwritten character recognition preprocessing pipeline.